people were not being tricked and Government was not for some obscure motive at the bottom of all their troubles'.[14]

All in all, therefore, the cumulative effect of these four different sources of discontent was that 'a soil was thus prepared to receive the seed by agitation which was focussed round the Rowlatt Act [and] the future of Turkey'.[15] The Rowlatt Act was significant because it 'recommended the continuation of repressive measures such as limiting the right to a jury trial in the case of certain political offenses and the suspension of *habeas corpus* through a provision that suspects might be detained because they were suspected of sedition'.[16] It was as a consequence of such measures that the nationalist Lala Lajpat Rai was assaulted during a protest March in October 1928. When he died in hospital, 'his death at the hands of the Punjab police gave rise to a new round political violence',[17] in which Bhagat Singh set out to avenge his death by wrongly firing upon J.P. Saunders in December 1928.

There is, however, a fifth reason which the 1919 secret report does not expressly cite. It is readily discernible from a closer analysis of the text. The increased repression and accompanying economic hardships of the time were bringing people of different faiths together in Punjab in a way that threatened to upset British rule in the province and which they wished to prevent. The British viewed their coming together with foreboding. As the meetings began to take place, '[t]he speeches at these gatherings were couched in a higher and higher key. No opportunity was lost of blaming Government for economic conditions and of alarming the people with the terms of the Rowlatt Bill, and there is no doubt that these inflammatory utterances began to influence the minds of the masses, imbuing them with the feeling that their sufferings were the direct result of the British Raj'.[18] Amid such turmoil, what actually gave the authorities a real cause for concern was that '[a]t the same time there may be seen a quiet and persistent attempt to bring Muhammadans into line with an agitation that was in its source Hindu. We find Hindus attending Muhammadan meetings and Muhammadans given the places of prominence in the general meetings,